

PREVIEW · SAMPLE PAGES

THE PROPOSAL SYSTEM

A structured proposal toolkit for independent creative professionals.

This is a 4-page preview of a 12-page proposal template, plus worksheets and clauses.
The full toolkit is available in the shop. No purchase is possible in demo mode.

SAMPLE PAGE 01

01

PROPOSAL TEMPLATE STRUCTURE

The template is twelve pages when fully filled in. The first page is the cover; the last page is the decision. The middle ten are the working document — scope, exclusions, approach, schedule, price, terms, and the supporting appendices.

WHAT'S IN THE TEMPLATE

— Cover	Buyer, project name, date, version, prepared-by.
— Situation	Quoted from the discovery call. Two paragraphs maximum.
— Scope	Named deliverables. Each as a noun.
— Exclusions	Named non-deliverables. Matching grammatical form.
— Approach	Phases, dependencies, decision points.
— Schedule	Weeks, not dates. Dates are confirmed on signature.
— Price & terms	Total, deposit, milestones, final, due dates, late fee.
— Revision tier	Light / Standard / Generous. Stated, not implied.
— Decision	What you need to start, by when, and the expiry.
— Appendix A	Commercial-assumptions checklist (signed).
— Appendix B	Delivery-formats and usage-license statement.
— Appendix C	Stakeholder list with roles (decides, reviews, affected).

Each section in the full template includes a one-paragraph usage note explaining how to fill it in, what to avoid, and where buyers most often push back.

SAMPLE PAGE 02

02

SCOPE WORKSHEET — SAMPLE

The scope worksheet is the page where most proposals go wrong. It is structured as three paired columns: what we will produce, what we will not produce, and the input the buyer must provide for each item.

WE WILL PRODUCE	WE WILL NOT PRODUCE	BUYER PROVIDES
Brand-mark in three lockup variations.	Sub-marks, illustrations, or iconography.	Existing brand research and stakeholder list.
One type system with display + body pairing.	Custom typeface design or lettering.	Approval on the type direction before round two.
Color system with named ratios for print + screen.	Production files for print, packaging, or signage.	Final Pantone references and substrate samples.
Application of the system to three named touchpoints.	Photography, illustration, or motion for those touchpoints.	Final copy for each touchpoint, in editable format.
A 16-page brand guidelines PDF.	An editable brand portal or ongoing brand management.	Confirmation of the deliverable format before round one.

The full worksheet includes 12 paired rows and a separate "surprise check" prompt at the bottom: name one thing the buyer would be surprised to learn is not included.

SAMPLE PAGE 03

03

COMMERCIAL-ASSUMPTIONS CHECKLIST

This is the page the buyer signs. It names the assumptions behind the price — so that if they change, the price changes. Silence on these points is how scope grows.

- ☐ The scope is as named in §3 of the proposal. Any addition is a change order.
- ☐ The schedule assumes one round of consolidated feedback per phase, within three business days.
- ☐ The price assumes delivery in the file formats named in Appendix B.
- ☐ The price assumes the buyer provides named inputs by the dates in §6.
- ☐ The deposit is non-refundable once work has begun.
- ☐ Travel, hosting, software, and stock are not included unless named.
- ☐ The support window after delivery is 14 calendar days.
- ☐ The license is for the named deliverable only — not for derivative works.
- ☐ The buyer warrants that all materials provided are cleared for use.
- ☐ The proposal is valid for 30 days from the date on the cover.

Signed: _____ Date: _____ On behalf of:

Margin / Form is a fictional creator business. This is a demonstration resource.